



Quantitative Methods in Political Science: Introduction

Lab Week 1 – 10/11 September 2026

About me

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- PhD student at the CDSS
- Interests: Parliamentary rhetoric and party behaviour, text-as-data and statistical modelling

Housekeeping

- Always feel free to ask questions
 - during the sessions
 - via email/slack
 - in the office hours
- There might be things you will not understand right away
 - try to engage with the material after the sessions and in the homeworks
- The workload for this course will increase very quickly throughout the semester
 - if you feel overwhelmed: talk to us (Joff, Or & Josh)
 - the university also offers [counselling](#)

Today's plan

1. Get [GitHub Org](#) running
2. Get Positron & Quarto running
3. Test homework submission
4. Some very quick refresher on R (please see the [Intro R course](#))
5. Centrality, summary stats, distributional plots
6. Some simple applications (*Try it*-examples)

Getting started with GitHub

- Open the GitHub organization (uni-mannheim-qm-2026)
- Create a homework repository for yourself via Github in the Browser:
 - “homework-” + your uni ID
 - Example: “homework-josalzma”, “homework-ab12cdef”
 - Keep it “private”, leave all other options untouched
- Don’t clone it yet! Refresh until you see some files in the repo.
- Only then, clone the repository
 - Green Code Button -> Open with Github Desktop
- Navigate to the ‘labs’ repository
- Clone the repository, too

Opening your repos in Positron / RStudio

- In Github Desktop
 - Windows: File -> Options -> Integrations -> External Editor: Custom
 - Mac: Github Desktop -> Settings -> Integrations -> External Editor: Custom
- Path: select your editor app:
 - Positron on Windows, it's in C:\Program Files\Positron or C:\Users\<username>\AppData\Local\Programs, select Positron.exe
 - Positron on Mac, search your Apps, select Positron
 - Save, leave the options view
- Repository -> Open in external editor
- In Github Desktop, Repository -> Show in explorer/finder
 - Positron: Right-click .code-workspace file, Open with: Positron
 - RStudio: Double-click .Rproj file (should open RStudio)
- In Positron: Open Folder / File -> Open Workspace from File
- In RStudio: Open Project

Fill in & render the test homework

- In your editor open the homework repo via Workspace / Folder / R Project
- Open w00/w00.qmd and follow the instructions
- Once you have rendered the w00.qmd to w00.pdf and w00.html make sure that you **save the changes** made to your w00.qmd
- Push/Commit your complete test submission (qmd, html, pdf = typst)

